

Not only does Perkins relish the deals like this that fill her own cupboards, she often donates surplus items to women's and homeless shelters. Her future project is a well-thought out plan of bartering for materials to build a house. Instead of using or selling a clinical strength deodorant that she got free with coupons, she has traded that same deodorant at the retail value of \$7.99 for an equal amount in locally grown foods or other items. Initially, she traded through Craigslist and the Farmer's Market, but Perkins plans on an ultimate barter when she and her husband begin building on land they've purchased. They plan on building their own eclectic, mortgage-free, "recycled" home made entirely of previously owned, bartered, or freecycled materials and labor. Her skill with couponing will help them get there.



CHRISTINE

Christine of Long Island, New York, isn't alone in her coupon habit. Both she and her husband are avid coupon users. Financially, they don't *need* to be. Their combined household income exceeds \$200,000 a year. Their house is completely paid off, and they own a vacation home and another investment property. Yet, thanks to prudent coupon use, they save over 75 percent on their weekly grocery bill. Not only that, but they have learned to always ask for a discount from merchants. Once, she got a hundred dollar discount for paying in cash at the dentist. Another time, it was a seven dollars a week discount on weekly landscaping.